

86.2 INTRODUCTORY "IT"

Certain set phrases beginning "it is" can be used at the start of a sentence. "It" is the subject of the sentence, and can be used to express a general truth or belief.



"IT" CLAUSE

INFINITIVE CLAUSE

It is easy **to** make mistakes in a new language.

Some "it" clauses are followed by a "to" infinitive.

"IT" CLAUSE

"THAT" CLAUSE

It is a shame **that** so many people give up.

Some "it" clauses are followed by "that" clauses.

FURTHER EXAMPLES INTRODUCTORY "IT"



It is important **to** be relaxed about making mistakes.



It's unlikely **that** you will be comfortable speaking aloud at first.



It is essential **to** give yourself time to study regularly.



It's true **that** being able to speak a second language is useful.



It is difficult **to** remember facts if you don't write them down.



It is often said **that** going to the country of the language helps.